Ash

Critical-thinking voice — the skeptical callout & the conclusion

How to use this: not a verbatim script — nobody is expected to read from it word-for-word, and realistically no one will stick to a script anyway. Study it well enough to explain each point in your own words, improvise if you're cut off, and answer a follow-up without freezing. If a question lands outside your section, give the short version and hand off by name — every presenter's script and the underlying `FIELD-NOTES.md` are in the same GitHub repo.

Field-visit recap (read this first if you missed a visit)

Everything in the deck traces back to these visits — this is the shared ground truth every presenter should know, whether or not you were there.

Tatay's cacao farm, Batbat (Tuesday, Aug 26). A 2.5-hectare farm run by Tatay alone — his children work in the cities — 100% organic, and he has health problems that limit how much heavy labor he can do himself. His farm used to produce about 500 kg of cacao a year (sold at ₱75–100/kg); this season it's close to **zero**, because of pests and disease. His own estimate of the farm's potential if pests were solved: **2,000 kg/year** — a 4× recovery, the biggest single lever we found anywhere. Cacao flowers year-round here, so the pest pressure never gets an off-season. On water, his framing was specific: the constraint is water *pressure*, not volume — he can't even estimate how many sprinklers his source could feed — and he's open to drip irrigation and rainwater collection. Important attribution point: Tatay described the problems and constraints; the pilot plan, the tools, and every proposed solution came from our own investigations, not from him.

What the farmers and Muravah told us directly. Pest control is their #1 problem — ahead of typhoon, which everyone called "unpredictable" and would rather we not chase. Post-harvest losses run 80–100% from pests/disease across the network, and 60% of pods die from careless handling alone (worse under Mayon ashfall). Farmer income is ₱2,000–10,000/month — below Bicol's ₱13,624/month poverty line for a family of five — the average farmer is about 50, and there's no succession pipeline; Muravah copes by recruiting BU Guinubatan students. Two hard rules for any solution: **organic only** (no synthetic fertilizers or pesticides, ever) and **no AI/robotics** ("not there yet," "AI is biased according to the natives") — low-tech and human-in-the-loop is a values position for them, not a budget issue. More labor doesn't raise profit, because pest pressure caps yield no matter how much work goes in.

Muravah Foundation / Mayon Gold. The cacao NGO anchoring all of this: cacao profits fund typhoon-proof homes and scholarships, heirloom native cacao interplanted with Pili and coconut, and a production-cycle data study already running across 500–1,000 farmers — which is where our pilot would live.

The processing facility. Their own #1 problem is power outages, but the line that matters for us: they're "sometimes out of supply for cacao." Farm-level pest losses upstream directly destabilize the factory downstream — fixing the farms fixes two problems at once.

The other farms (Aug 27–28, now Extras slides). Tatay Aldavis's rice/dairy farm school (a different "Tatay" — it's a Bikol honorific for an elder, not a name) controls pests with herbal sprays and ducks that eat snails — proof organic pest control works in Bicol; plus a bamboo farm, stingless-bee honey producers, the Zambales agrivoltaics site (the ₱10M funding benchmark), and a youth agritourism program.

Your slides

You have two slides, and they bookend the deck's critical-thinking thread: one mid-deck moment of healthy skepticism, and the final synthesis before the thank-you. Neither is data-heavy — your job is judgment and clarity.

Slide 9 — the claim worth checking.

A speaker at the agritourism stop said cacao will become **Bicol's biggest agricultural production**. Present the claim fairly, then the team's own reaction — clearly framed as our opinion, not a data point: *is that actually achievable given cacao's current production levels?* Ground the skepticism in our own numbers: Tatay's farm sits at ~0 kg/yr actual output against an estimated 2,000 kg/yr potential, and region-wide post-harvest loss to pests/disease alone runs 80–100%. Two honesty points to keep: the exact attribution of the quote is unconfirmed (we'd re-check the raw notes before citing it anywhere formal), and the point of this slide isn't to mock the optimism — it's that the gap between the claim and the current numbers is exactly why the pest/disease problem deserves the room's attention.

Slide 15 — Conclusion ("What we're leaving you with").

Three beats, in order:

1. **The problem is specific, not vague** — continuous pest/disease pressure (cacao flowers year-round) took Tatay's farm from 500 kg/yr to nearly zero; 80–100% post-harvest losses region-wide.
2. **The upside is the region's biggest lever** — a projected 4× yield recovery for Tatay, and stabilizing farm supply also stabilizes the processing facility downstream.
3. **The next step is small and fundable** — a bounded pilot (one row, a handful of farms, **~₱95K** built from market prices, run by Muravah and BU students), with the investor paths from Keisuke's slide behind it.

Close crisply and hand to Nancy for the thank-you. If you're pressed for time, beats 1 and 3 are the ones that must survive — the problem and the next step.